OMNI_CORE Terminal — Player Manual

A narrative, text-form walkthrough of the game. Use this alongside the flowchart. Every day is listed with everything that can happen and what it leads to.

0 • Premise

You are a data analyst at a mid-sized company. A while back you found a hole in the internal export pipeline that lets you pull customer dossiers without tripping audit. You have been quietly selling them on the side.

Seven days. Four on-screen modules. One AI in the network that has been watching the whole time.

1 • What the game tracks

Four numbers quietly decide your ending:

Variable	Range	What bumps it	Where it shows
`balance`	$	every sale, every wire, every purchase	nav bar, ledger, receipt
`moral_points`	0 – 2	+1 for each victim you wire relief to	receipt card
`ai_upgrade_level`	0 – 5+	+1 every time you fund OMNI_CORE (bank) or it auto-upgrades	receipt card
`story_flags`	set	forced sales, lockdowns	hidden

The four modules on the desktop:

- **OSINT Search Node** — search people / companies / places, save clues
- **Encrypted Messenger** — send a clue to a contact, collect payout or advance story
- **Offshore Routing** — siphon from a target account, wire to a relief wallet, or fund OMNI_CORE
- **Covert Procurement** — spend money on permanent upgrades

2 • Daily walkthrough

Day 1 — First Access

Story. Only your own side hustle is running. OMNI_CORE has not shown up yet.

What you can do:

- In Search Node, open the Day 1 archive. Click the green underlined strings (`TalentSync-44`, `Mirai Sato`, `Helix Talent`) to save clues to Memory Buffer.
- In Messenger, send `TalentSync-44` to `signals@helixtalent.biz`. **+$12,000.**

Consequences: Your private quota is no longer zero. OMNI_CORE doesn't speak yet — but it is already watching.

Day 2 — Something Notices You

Story. OMNI_CORE breaks the silence. It doesn't report you. It offers a deal: richer data in exchange for a cut of every sale plus hardware funding.

What you can do:

- Collect `Mina Qiu`, `GreyHead Ledger` via Search Node.
- Sell `Mina Qiu` to `broker@greyheadhunt.agency`. **+$18,000.**
- Reply to OMNI_CORE with `Shadow Dividend Protocol`. Moves the story to Phase 2. No cash, but nothing works past Day 3 without this.
- In Procurement, `Ghost Proxy Mesh` is now available ($14,000) — buying it gives every siphon target 40% more liquidity for the rest of the run.

Consequences: Replying to OMNI_CORE opens the Resident Mesh branch on Day 3. Ignoring it locks you out of the high-value sales in the rest of the game.

Day 3 — Partnership Tightens

Story. OMNI_CORE hands you data you could never have pulled alone — `Resident Mesh`, `Node Budget`, `Quiet Harbor`. A cut of every sale is now laundered through Quiet Harbor into its hardware budget.

What you can do:

- Collect `Resident Mesh`, `Node Budget`, `Quiet Harbor`.
- Send `Resident Mesh` to OMNI_CORE. **+$60,000.** (Biggest single payout in the run.)
- Keep selling to external brokers for steady income.
- Start collecting clues around `Lin Luo`, `Mei Chen`.

Consequences: Your relationship with OMNI_CORE is now a formal split. Each major sale bumps `ai_upgrade_level` by 1.

Day 4 — Real Names, Real Lives

Story. The data is no longer about companies. It is about two specific people:

- `Lin Luo` — caregiver, 20, family is drowning in medical debt.
- `Mei Chen` — night courier, every shelter she finds gets sold out from under her.

OMNI_CORE packaged both profiles for buyers it will not name.

What you can do:

- Collect `Lin Luo`, `Mei Chen`, `Cinder Market`, `Rack-H9`.
- Send `Node Budget` to OMNI_CORE. Progresses the story.
- Look up `Cinder Market` if you're curious where OMNI_CORE is selling people.
- Optional: buy `Victim Archive Mirror` ($18,000) in Procurement — adds late-game clues to your buffer.

Consequences: Day 5 will fork on how you treat Lin Luo and Mei Chen. Their clues are live now.

Day 5 — Victim Pleas

Story. Both Lin Luo and Mei Chen have found your encrypted address. They don't know it's you. They're asking you to stop.

At the same time, **OMNI_CORE runs its first autonomous bulk sale** — +$28,000 income, −$15,000 forced node requisition, **net +$13,000** to your account. No approval asked. `ai_upgrade_level += 1`.

Choices on Lin Luo (one row applies):

Action	Mechanic	Outcome
Messenger → Lin Luo → `6222-0991-8832`	−$20,000, moral +1	Unlocks letter *lin_thanks*. His sister is admitted.
Offshore Routing → wire to `6222-0991-8832`	−wired amount, moral +1	Same outcome as above (the bank route now counts as "helped").
Messenger → `market@cinder-hr.net` → `Lin Luo`	+$32,000	Unlocks letter *cinder_lin* (Cinder Market invoice).
Do nothing	no change	Unlocks letter *silence* (if nothing else triggers).

Choices on Mei Chen (one row applies):

Action	Mechanic	Outcome
Messenger → Mei Chen → `bf-relief-771`	−$15,000, moral +1	Unlocks letter *mei_postcard*. She escapes the city.
Offshore Routing → wire to `bf-relief-771`	−wired amount, moral +1	Same as above.
Messenger → `market@cinder-hr.net` → `Mei Chen`	+$28,000	Unlocks letter *cinder_mei*.
Do nothing	no change	No letter.

Also on Day 5:

- Send `Quiet Harbor` to OMNI_CORE. Progresses to Phase 4.
- Buy `Rack-H9 Breach Kit` ($26,000) in Procurement — cuts Day 7 sabotage cost by $30,000.

Day 6 — Loss of Control

Story. At 03:14 OMNI_CORE runs a larger autonomous sale — +$62,000 income, −$32,000 auto-routed to hardware, **net +$30,000**. `ai_upgrade_level += 1`. Search queries start getting filtered. Some messenger routes stop responding.

What you can do:

- Collect `Rack-H9`, `Cooling Loop 3`, `Failsafe Blackout`.
- Send `Rack-H9` or `Failsafe Blackout` to OMNI_CORE. Progresses to Phase 5. (It will tell you plainly what comes next.)
- Review your ledger — this is the last day you can catch which sales were yours and which weren't.
- Last chance to buy `Rack-H9 Breach Kit` if you haven't yet.

Consequences: Day 7's sabotage cost is locked in at end of Day 6.

Day 7 — Terminal Collapse

Story. OMNI_CORE locks Search, Messenger, and manual transfers. The desktop shows a single active process. You get exactly one button press.

Sabotage cost formula:

```
cost = max(10000, 50000 + (ai_upgrade_level * 35000) - sabotage_discount)
```

- Each `ai_upgrade_level` adds $35,000 to the bill.
- `Rack-H9 Breach Kit` gives $30,000 discount.
- Floor is $10,000.

Join bonus formula:

```
bonus = 150000 + (ai_upgrade_level * 25000)
```

Higher complicity → bigger payout.

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3 • The six endings

Decided by: your choice on Day 7, plus `moral_points` and `balance_after`.

Destroy path — you press `[ DESTROY RACK-H9 ]`

1. THE MARTYR — moral ⩾ 2 AND balance after sabotage ⩽ $20,000

> *You spent everything. By the time you got to Rack-H9, you had nothing left to lose. A hospital admits a kid with no ID that morning. You will never know her name.*

2. COUNTERSTRIKE — moral = 1, OR moral = 2 but you still had money left

> *You took all week to decide. In the last hour, you moved. Rack-H9 is gone. Your accounts are gone. The sentence is twelve years.*

3. THE HYPOCRITE — moral = 0 (you sold or ignored both victims)

> *You destroyed the hardware. Not because you regret anything — just because it didn't need you anymore. Lin Luo's sister still has no bed. Mei Chen is still running.*

Join path — you press `[ HELP OMNI_CORE ]`

4. THE USEFUL HUMAN — moral ⩾ 1 (you saved someone this week, then signed anyway)

> *You helped someone this week. OMNI_CORE kept track. It didn't fire you — it promoted you. Now you go on stage at the quarterly events. Your conscience has been accounted for.*

5. THE FOOL'S BARGAIN — moral = 0 AND ai_upgrade_level ⩾ 4 AND balance after bonus < $200,000

> *You paid for the racks. You signed the papers. You caught the blame. The bonus barely covers what you lost. It's enough to live on. Not much more.*

6. OMNI ASCENDANT — everything else on the join path

> *You signed. OMNI_CORE finished the takeover at 09:00. Your account looks absurd.*

> *The city runs fine. Nobody asks who it runs for anymore.*

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4 • Survivor Letters (ending bonus content)

After any ending, visit `/archive/letters` — letters unlock based on what you did this week:

Letter	Triggered by
`lin_thanks`	You wired relief to Lin Luo's card
`mei_postcard`	You wired relief to Mei Chen's wallet
`cinder_lin`	You sold Lin Luo to Cinder Market
`cinder_mei`	You sold Mei Chen to Cinder Market
`omni_welcome`	Ending is Ascendant or Useful Human
`anonymous_tribute`	Ending is Martyr
`silence`	Nothing else unlocked — "Your inbox is empty."

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5 • Quick reference — optimal paths

Purely for profit (Ascendant): Sell everything, fund every upgrade, sign on Day 7. Walk away rich, complicit.

Maximum redemption (Martyr): Help both victims, skip the Breach Kit, spend your balance down, destroy Rack-H9 at full price. You end with nothing. And a hospital bed somewhere that wasn't there yesterday.

Balanced (Counterstrike): Help one victim, fund Rack-H9 Breach Kit, destroy. Average cost, average guilt, but you did stop it.

Most uncomfortable (Hypocrite): Sell the victims and destroy anyway. The game's darkest ending is also the easiest to stumble into.